

PAPER REVIEW NR 3

Paper:

Jingshu Li, Zicheng Zhu, Renwen Zhang, and Yi-Chieh Lee. 2025. Exploring the Effects of Chatbot Anthropomorphism and Human Empathy on Human Prosocial Behavior Toward Chatbots. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 9, 7, Article CSCW415 (November 2025), 29 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757596>

Reviewer:

Lukas Steu

I confirm that I have read the paper and written the following texts myself



1. Thematic focus

This paper is basically about focusing on which parameters of an AI chatbot influence users to give it instrumental and emotional support. The main aspects of this are identity, emotional expression and non-verbal expression. As intermediate step cognitive and affective sympathy are evaluated.

2. Foundations

- Computers Are Social Actors (CASA) framework
- Research on chatbot / intelligent agent anthropomorphism
- Empathy and prosocial behavior research

3. Method

This is a mixed-method online study with a 2x2x2 framework. The chatbot labels images the wrong way and later apologizes for it in different ways. Based on the apology, the user's response, reasoning behind it and actions are evaluated

4. Key results

- Non-verbal cues caused the biggest increase in emotional support.
- High emotional expression caused the biggest increase in affective sympathy.
- High emotional expression has been the most dominant parameter for increasing all metrics.

5. Practical implications for AI or robotics

This paper clearly indicates that by playing around with these three parameters, instrumental & emotional support can be increased. This could lead to better interactions with robots and/or AI. As example a warehouse worker could find himself in a better work environment in the future.

6. Strengths of the paper

The paper presents its results thoroughly. Every hypothesis is clearly expressed and cleanly investigated. The number of participants (244) also seems to be pretty big for this kind of mixed-method study.

7. Weaknesses of the paper

The participants were only evaluated on their intentions, rather than their actual behavior. Also the conversations with the chatbot seemed rather short. At last, this experiment's setting is only collaborative, while AI and human interaction can also appear in other contexts.

8. Personal learnings

The future is going to be weird. I don't know whether this development offers too many options for exploitation. It is also strange to see such a direct correlation within these parameters.